

Value, Price and the Seesaw.

Where the deal actually lives.

Session 28 · Friday 5 June 2026 · Marketing Sweet

THE MENTAL MODEL

VALUE

what they're getting

PRICE

what they pay

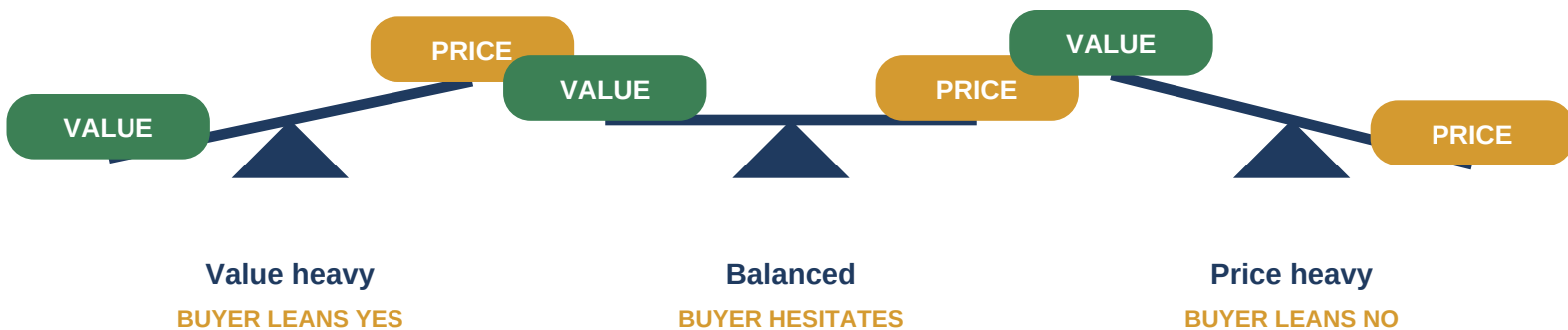
When value is heavy, price doesn't matter as much.

When value is light, the price is all the buyer sees.

01 · THE MENTAL MODEL

The Seesaw

Three states. One model. Everything else is consequence.

**THE INSIGHT**

"Price only matters in the absence of value. Sell value — the seesaw will do the rest."

TWO CONSEQUENCES

1. When the buyer pushes on price, the rep's instinct is to push back on price. That's the trap. Push back on VALUE.

Build value through the whole call

Features + benefits + proof.
Stack the left side.

Don't drop price unilaterally

It lifts value off the seesaw — half of it, not just \$100.

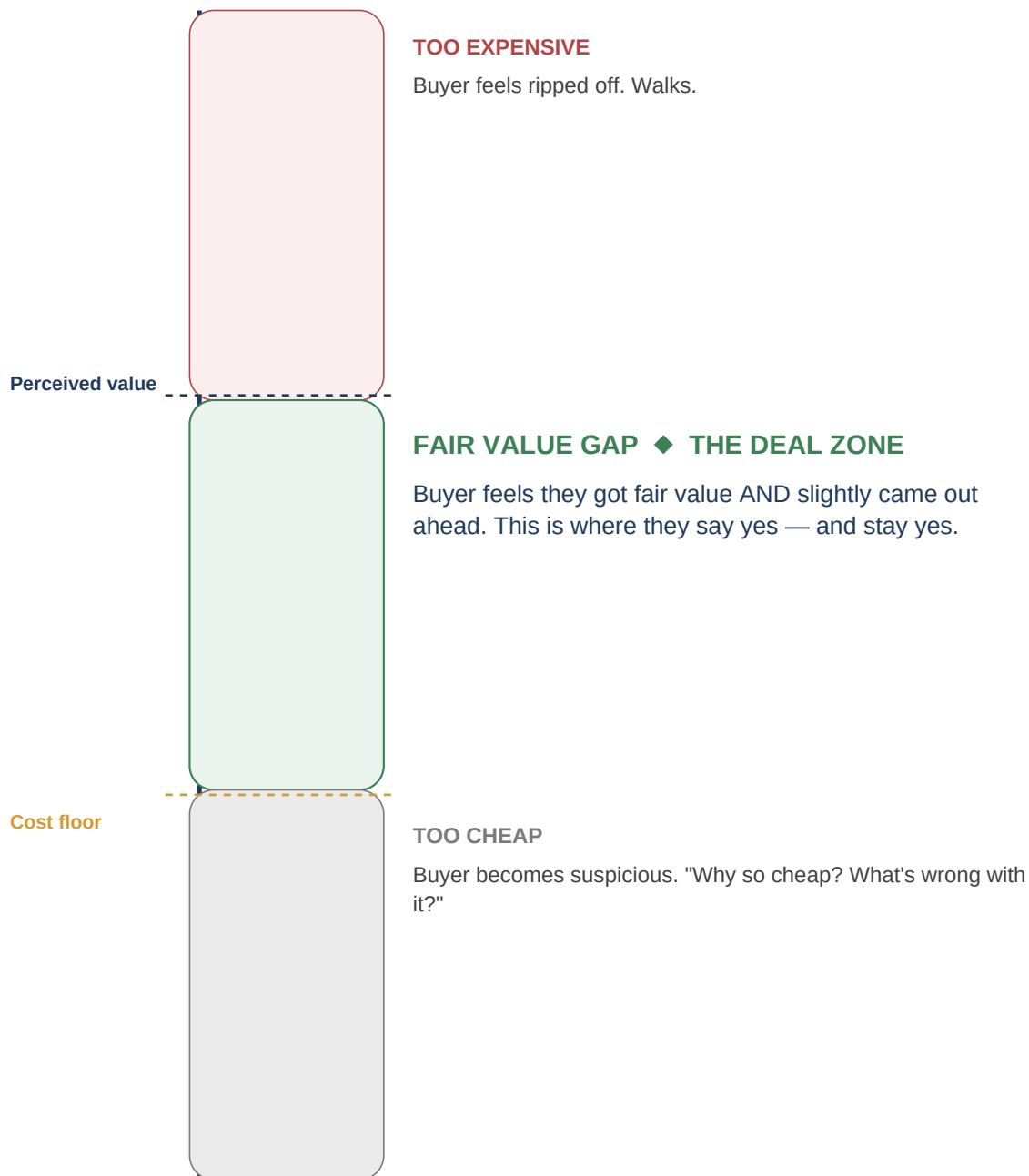
Drop price WITH a counterweight

Add referrals as you remove dollars. See Page 4.

02 · THE SWEET ZONE

The Fair Value Gap

Buyers say yes inside the gap. Not above. Not below.

**THE GOAL**

Land the price inside the gap, so the buyer feels they got fair value — and beat you slightly.

03 · THE FIX

The Referral Counterweight

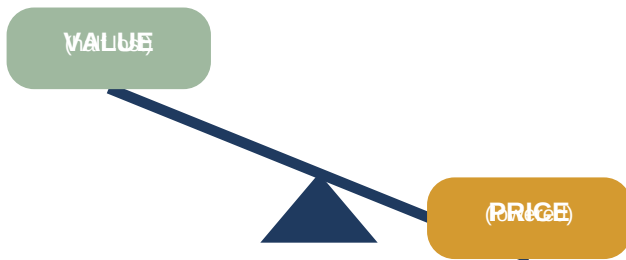
Take price off. Put referrals on. The seesaw stays balanced.

BEFORE · Unilateral price drop

Price ↓ but value drops 50% too

AFTER · With referral counterweight

Price ↓ AND value ↑ (referrals add weight)



THE TRADE — AND WHY IT'S ASYMMETRIC

- Buyer gives up:** 5–7 names of similar businesses. Roughly zero personal cost.
- Buyer gets:** Lower price, same package, AND a rep with 5–7 reasons to deliver.
- Rep gives up:** Some margin on this deal.
- Rep gets:** Pipeline worth ~10x the cold-call equivalent. Skin-in-the-game on delivery.

THE WORD CHOICE THAT MAKES IT WORK

DON'T SAY

"I'll give you a discount."

Tells the buyer the price was inflated and they can push for more.

DO SAY

"...under one contingency."

Frames it as a conditional trade. Value stays. Buyer feels the trade is symmetric.

04 · RUN IT VERBATIM

The Six-Step Script

Learn the wording. Adapt the names. Trust the structure.

01**Buyer names a lower price.**

"I don't think I can quite get there, but let me check with the director — give me 5 minutes."

02**"Call the director." Step away. Come back.**

"I've got some fantastic news — approval to give you the exact package you want, just under one contingency."

03**Reveal the contingency.**

"Most of my business comes from referrals. Do you know anyone in business that might benefit from what we do?"

04**Cool them down and collect names.**

"Just first names — no business names. I just need it for the director. Five or six is great."

05**Set the timeline + the close.**

"If we do a great job for you in 3–4 months, would you be happy to introduce me? I'll send you the email template — you literally forward it."

06**Optional sweetener.**

"If any of them sign up, I'll talk to the director about giving you a month off." Use sparingly.

05 · GUARDRAILS

When NOT to Use It

The move is powerful. Wrong situation = wrong outcome.

DON'T**Buyer is well below fair value**

If they want \$200 for a \$625 package, the gap is too wide for referrals to bridge. Walk away politely. Don't burn down your own pricing.

DON'T**Buyer isn't networked**

A sole trader with no industry peers can't deliver referrals. Try a different lever — longer contract, smaller package, payment terms.

DON'T**Value hasn't been built yet**

If the buyer hasn't bought the value, the contingency just looks like a confused discount. Build value first. Trade only at the close.

DON'T**Delivery is uncertain**

If you collect referrals and the campaign underperforms, trust collapses and the names never come. Only trade if you can deliver.

THE COUNTERWEIGHT IS A SCALPEL, NOT A SLEDGEHAMMER · USE IT WHEN IT FITS

REFERENCE

Daily Card · Keep By the Phone

The whole session on one page.

THE MODEL

- ◆ Value on one side, price on the other. Sell value.
- ◆ Aim for the fair value gap — buyer feels they came out slightly ahead.
- ◆ Drop price alone → value drops 50%. Don't do it.

THE TRADE

- ◆ When you take dollars off, put referrals on. Counterweight.
- ◆ Aim for 5–7 names per deal. 3 is the floor. 16 is the ceiling.
- ◆ Reps with the names have skin in the game — buyers feel it.

THE WORDS

- ◆ "...under one contingency" — never "discount."
- ◆ "Most of my business comes from referrals — do you know anyone?"
- ◆ "Just first names — no business names — I need them for the director."

AFTER THE CLOSE

- ◆ Schedule the 3–4 month referral call IN your calendar at close.
- ◆ Send the buyer the email template — make it forward-ready.
- ◆ If campaign hits target, collect. If it doesn't, fix first, ask later.

PRICE DOESN'T MATTER AS MUCH AS YOU THINK · IT ONLY MATTERS IN THE ABSENCE OF VALUE